

Nerds prefer to use technical terms and jargon, which may sound unfamiliar to others. On the other hand, geeks like to speak in clear precise terms without causing any confusion. Geeks are always interested in the microscopic details in life. For instance, they may find a certain situation in life to be similar to events in a novel that they have read. Ross from “Friends” is a good example of a geek, who was almost unfairly labelled as a nerd by his F.R.I.E.N.D.S

Nerds are more interested in engaging in solitary pursuits such as computer programming and games like chess, while the geek likes to play board games, watch movies, listen to music etc. Geeks are also able to express themselves better than nerds.

Nerds are usually associated with jobs requiring the application of science, technology, engineering and mathematics. For instance nerds are most likely to build rockets and IT software and will likely having advanced college degrees. However, the traits of a geek and nerd often overlap and the two can be engaged in similar domains. To illustrate, geeks are also present in IT departments, engineering, mathematical tasks and even video game development.

To cut a long story short, neither nerds or geeks are boring. However, you could think of nerds as toned-down versions of geeks who are yet to explore their full potential.

WHY WE LOVE BEING GEEKY

From being greatly hated to being adored, geeks have come a long way. The modern geeks are no longer bespectacled people with no sense of personal grooming. In fact, as Digit readers, you already know that the clichéd concept of geeks being uncool is long gone. Even Hollywood’s portrayal of the geeks has changed over time. Where once they were shown to be reclusive and unpopular, new movies portray them as the epitome of the good guy. The geeks are shown as the “it” people who have it all figured out and are the magnet of all things positive!

This major change in how geeks are perceived is thought to be a result of the dawn of the internet and other technological advancements. It was a geek, Mark Zuckerberg, who introduced the world to Facebook. It was through

his innovative ideas that the whole world is now connected to each other and cannot wait to share what’s on their mind.

Bill Gates and Steve Jobs introduced personal computing to the world, thanks to which came smartphones and tablets, which have become an indispensable part of our lives. Imagine life without internet – you have a geek to thank for that!

When people meet geeks they feel that the person may in the future create something useful, which will help humankind. (We’re looking at you Elon Musk). This belief in the superior intellect of the geeks has perhaps driven the change of outlook towards them. These changes have undoubtedly increased the likeability of a geek.

SPOTTING A GEEK

It is difficult to quantify qualities that a geek could possess. However, some traits stand out. And clichéd as they may sound, can help identify the potential geek lurking in your neighbourhood!

Geeks possess an incredible passion. Every person has some kind of a hobby, but a geek will go to extreme lengths to attain expertise in the area they are almost compulsively obsessive about. Be it gaming, comic books or something else, geeks are like the human version of Google or Siri when it comes to their area of interest. Simply pop them a question related to their interest and they will patiently share the details. A knowledgeable geek is akin to a search engine on steroids, you get multiple answers to a single query!

Why is this so? Because a geek is extremely devoted to their passions and would possibly sacrifice everything just to gain more knowledge on the subject. This passion can almost be thought of as the reason for their existence!

Geeks feel they are distinct from the general populace due to their immense knowledge about a subject. They feel a disconnect with people who do not share the same level of enthusiasm over the activity as they do. However, they are quick to connect with like-minded people. Non-geeks might often have trouble communicating with a geek who possesses much greater knowledge about a subject.

Geeks are also known to be so engaged in an activity that they lose track of time. Geeks become so immersed in the activity that they may not be aware of just how long they have spent on that particular activity. For instance, in case of gamers, a new video game may draw in a gamer geek to such an extent that he is un-

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To G.E.E.K or not to geek that is the question